

Braze Competitive Intelligence



Overview of Braze vs Marketing Cloud

Key differences between Braze and Marketing Cloud center around data management, segmentation capabilities, and platform integration. Marketing Cloud offers stronger native integration with Salesforce platforms while Braze focuses on mobile-first engagement.



Higher Education Sector Analysis

Marketing Cloud demonstrates particular strengths for higher education institutions through:

- Deep integration with Education Cloud and existing Salesforce implementations [\[1\]](#)
- Automated subscriber management and contact deletion capabilities, as demonstrated at Griffith University [\[2\]](#)
- Ability to handle complex institutional hierarchies and household-level segmentation [\[3\]](#)



Usability Comparison

Marketing Cloud Next vs Braze

Marketing Cloud Next offers:

- AI-powered campaign creation through Agentforce [\[4\]](#)
- Drag-and-drop segmentation tools that don't require technical expertise [\[3\]](#)
- Native integration with Salesforce platform for unified data [\[5\]](#)

Braze positions itself with:

- Mobile-first architecture [\[6\]](#)
- Quick initial setup but limited long-term scalability [\[7\]](#)
- API-driven architecture that requires technical resources for complex use cases [\[8\]](#)



Integration Benefits

With Existing Salesforce Implementation

Marketing Cloud provides:

- Unified customer profiles across Sales, Service and Marketing Clouds [\[3\]](#)

- Native Data Cloud integration enabling real-time data access [\[9 · Canvas\]](#)
- Seamless connection with Education Cloud for student engagement [\[2\]](#)

Marketing Cloud Engagement Compatibility

Recent developments include:

- Marketing Cloud Next features becoming accessible through Engagement+ [\[10\]](#)
- Shared usage buckets between platforms [\[11\]](#)
- Unified analytics across Marketing Cloud products [\[12 · Google Slides\]](#)

⚠ Implementation Considerations

For digitally immature organizations:

- Initial learning curve with Marketing Cloud terminology and concepts [\[13\]](#)
- Need for guided experiences during transformation [\[13\]](#)
- Recommendation to start with simpler use cases like journey analytics before advancing to complex features [\[13\]](#)

🔍 Data Management Capabilities

Marketing Cloud offers superior data management through:

- Comprehensive data management via Marketing Cloud + Data Cloud [\[9 · Canvas\]](#)
- Advanced household-level segmentation capabilities [\[3\]](#)
- Real-time data access and activation [\[9 · Canvas\]](#)

Braze limitations include:

- Single Snowflake schema/table restriction [\[9 · Canvas\]](#)
- Manual data processes for complex segmentation [\[3\]](#)
- Limited marketer-friendly segmentation tools [\[9 · Canvas\]](#)